

ter than those of 6 and Josephus to rectify the order of Pers. kings in the later bks. of the O.T. The Behistûn Inscr. knows Gubaru as a Persian, against Wilson's vain attempts to prove the possibility of his being a Mede. Further, the more we know of Gobryas the less can we assign him royal rank. It is well-nigh impossible that a highest noble could have been given the title even popularly, still less by a member of the Pers. court, as the seer Daniel is alleged to have been. Such a title could have been nothing less than high treason, involving the subject as well as the writer. But the Biblical Darius the Mede acts as omnipotent autocrat over a vast empire of 120 satrapies,<sup>9</sup> and the *ne plus ultra* of royal autocracy appears in the edict he signs that none should worship any god or man but himself. Neither Gobryas nor Cambyses, in his father's lifetime, could have perpetrated such an absurdity. For explanation of the story we can only make surmises. For local reasons not known to us the great Darius I, who made Cyrus' domain into an organized empire, who had to punish Babylon for its rebelliousness in his early days, may have passed as a Mede, and there being no place for him in the line of the four Pers. kings known to the Bible, may have been made the representative of the supposititious Median kingdom and so been placed before Cyrus. In him the captures of Babylon by Gobryas and Darius I may have been compounded, and in so far we may have a residuum of tradition.<sup>10</sup>

etc.; in Pinches, *PSBA* 38 (1916), 29 f., of Cambyses' 4th year, similar to the Nies texts (the title of governorship of Abar-Nahara is omitted). In the Behistûn Inscr. there is ref. to Gubaru-Gaubaruua, in §68 in trilingual form, in §71 in OPers. alone, Gubaru being termed 'son of Mardonia, a Persian,' and appearing as one of Darius' field-marsals (s. Weissbach, 'Die Keilinschriften d. Achämeniden,' in *Vorderas. Bibliothek*). Gobryas appears as a leading personage in Herodotus for the events in Darius I's reign (iii, 70, etc.), while he figures largely in Xenophon's *Cyrus Romance*, the *Cyropaedia*. Below in sub-section (e) will be given a summary of the story told in viii, 5, of his seizure of the palace in Babylon and the killing of the Bab. king; most of the anecdotes about Gobryas concern his relations with Darius. The historical value of these Gr. traditions is fully discussed by Schwenzner. See also for an earlier discussion C. F. Lehmann-Haupt, 'Gobryas u. Belsazar bei Xenophon,' *Klio*, 1902, 341-5.

<sup>9</sup> Technically a woful exaggeration, excusable only from the later degenerated use of 'satrap'; s. at 3<sup>d</sup>.

<sup>10</sup> Cf. Behrmann, p. xix, Dr., p. liv, Cornill, *Int.*, 258, against which line of argument cf. Wilson, cc. 10-12. Cambyses' acts of sacrilege in Egypt may have given rise to this fable of royal claim of deity, yet Darius appears in the story as a friendly character. But the theme belonged to the common satire of Jewish story; acc. to Judith 3<sup>d</sup> Neb. gave an edict that he alone should be worshipped.